

— EDITION 01

Anthropic just became a chip company

The company that makes Claude is now hiring people to design silicon. Almost nobody noticed.

A 8-part breakdown

SWIPE >>>>

01 / 08

| It came out in a job listing.

On 5 August 2026, Anthropic confirmed for the first time that it is building an in-house silicon team to design custom chips for Claude. No keynote. A careers page and a short statement.

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| Salary: \$320k to \$485k.

The listing spans front-end design, pre-silicon verification, physical design, design-for-test, analog and mixed-signal, foundry and packaging. That is a real chip org, not a side project.

03 / 08

Why a model company cares about transistors.

Anthropic sells intelligence by the token. The price of a token is set inside a data centre full of chips it mostly rents. Co-designing silicon with Claude targets roughly a 50% cut in per-token inference cost.

04 / 08

Compute is the constraint.

Its compute base is expanding around 4.5x in eighteen months. Run-rate revenue has gone from about \$9B at the end of 2025 to over \$30B. When compute is the bottleneck, you go and buy the bottleneck.

05 / 08

Everyone is building their way out.

Google has TPUs. Amazon has Trainium. Meta has MTIA. OpenAI unveiled Jalapeno with Broadcom in June 2026. Nvidia still holds roughly 70% of the market, which is why the rest are moving.

06 / 08

Anthropic is last, on purpose.

Its chip sits *inside* a multi-vendor stack alongside AWS, Google, Nvidia and AMD. It does not replace them. That restraint is more convincing than a hero chip.

07 / 08

Hardware is not a dead end anymore.

For fifteen years the advice was to learn to code because software eats the world. The AI bottleneck has moved from the model to the machine, and the money moved with it.

08 / 08

| If you graduate soon, prep for these.

Chip design and verification. ML systems engineering. Compiler and kernel work. Hardware-software co-design. Majors that map: EE, computer engineering, CS with real systems depth, applied maths.

— THE TAKEAWAY

The machine matters again.

The software did not escape the machine.
It made the machine matter more. Follow
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